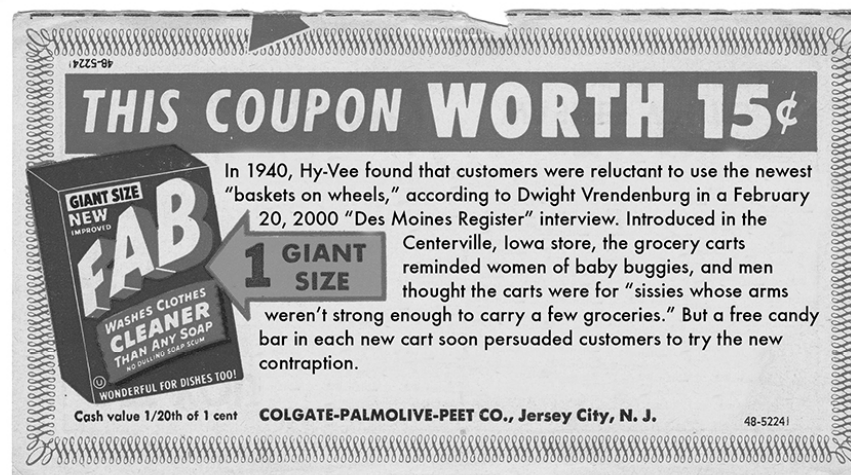


in bags pumped full of oxygen, all systems were go for this innovative promotion. The promotion consisted of free-standing displays known as “nearpacks” (so called because they contained the premiums and were designed for display near the packs of detergent). Each nearpack came with plastic containers and even a net for scooping the fish out of the tank they were displayed in. Spic and Span’s nearpack launch coincided with Proctor & Gamble’s annual spring cleaning sale, with an early spring debut.

What the marketers hadn’t counted on was the unpredictable weather. Goldfish shipped to Minnesota hit a cold snap and arrived frozen. Shipments to the Southwest hit an early heat wave and were parboiled. Salespeople were called to stores all over to pick up dead fish and clean up messes from broken bags.



Promos and premiums weren’t just for the consumer. The stores were often enticed to order more stock with what were called “dealer loaders,” which were offered to a retailer for placing a larger than normal order. According to Rod Taylor in a June 2004 *Promo* magazine article, one of the